Lumora Digital - Leave and Remote Work Policy

About this document

Lumora Digital is a fictional company invented for the AskHR demo. This policy is sample content written for testing only. It does not describe any real employer and must not be used as HR advice. Version 1.2, effective 1 January 2026. Owner: People Team (people@lumora.example).

1. Who this policy covers

This policy applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees of Lumora Digital in every office. Interns and contractors are covered only by sections 4 (public holidays) and 9 (remote work), unless their contract says otherwise. Where local law gives an employee more generous rights than this policy, local law always wins.

2. Annual leave entitlement

Full-time employees receive 18 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Part-time employees receive the same entitlement pro rata to their contracted hours. For example, an employee who works three days a week receives 18 x 3 / 5 = 10.8 days, rounded up to 11 days.

Leave accrues monthly at one twelfth of the yearly entitlement. New joiners may take leave from their first month, up to the amount accrued so far. After five full years of service, the entitlement increases to 20 days; after ten years, to 22 days. The increase applies from the first day of the calendar year after the anniversary.

3. Requesting annual leave

Employees request leave in the HR portal. Requests of up to three consecutive days need at least five working days of notice. Requests of four days or more need at least four weeks of notice. Managers should answer every request within three working days. A request that has not been answered after five working days is approved automatically.

Managers may refuse a request only for a clear business reason, such as a product release or a minimum staffing level, and must explain the reason in writing. During December no more than half of a team may be on leave at the same time; requests are approved in the order they were received.

4. Public holidays

Employees receive the public holidays of the country where their contract is held, in addition to annual leave. An employee who is asked to work on a public holiday receives a replacement day off, to be taken within two months. If the replacement day cannot be taken within two months, it is paid at 1.5 times the normal daily rate instead.

5. Carrying over unused leave

Employees are encouraged to use their full entitlement every year. Up to 5 days of unused annual leave may be carried over to the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March of that year; any carried-over days not taken by then are lost.

Days above the carry-over limit are lost on 31 December, with two exceptions. First, if a manager cancelled approved leave for business reasons, those days may be carried over in addition to the 5-day limit. Second, an employee who could not take leave because of long-term sick leave or

parental leave may carry over all unused days, to be used within 12 months of returning to work. Unused annual leave is not paid out, except when employment ends.

6. Sick leave

Employees who are ill should tell their manager before 10:00 on the first day of absence, by phone or chat. Up to 10 days of paid sick leave are available per calendar year. For absences of one or two days, no medical certificate is needed. From the third consecutive day of absence, a medical certificate is required and should be uploaded to the HR portal within five days.

Sick leave does not reduce annual leave. If an employee falls ill during annual leave and provides a medical certificate, the sick days are returned to their annual leave balance. Employees with a long-term illness should speak to the People Team about extended sick pay, a phased return to work and reasonable adjustments.

7. Parental leave

Birth parents receive 16 weeks of paid parental leave at full pay. The second parent, including adoptive and same-sex parents, receives 4 weeks of paid leave at full pay, to be taken within the first 12 months after the birth or adoption. Leave can start up to 4 weeks before the expected date of birth.

Employees should tell the People Team at least 15 weeks before the expected week of birth, or as soon as reasonably possible for adoptions. Annual leave continues to accrue during parental leave. After parental leave, an employee may request part-time work or a flexible schedule for up to 12 months, and the company will agree unless there is a serious business reason not to.

8. Other paid leave

Bereavement leave: up to 5 paid days on the death of a partner, child, parent or sibling, and 2 paid days for other close relatives. Marriage leave: 3 paid days for the employee's own wedding or civil partnership. Moving house: 1 paid day per calendar year. Jury service and other public duties: paid leave for the time required, after the employee shares the official notice with their manager.

Study leave: employees on an approved learning plan may take up to 5 paid days per year for exams and exam preparation. Volunteering: every employee may take 2 paid days per year to volunteer with a registered charity.

9. Remote work

Lumora Digital works in a hybrid model. Employees in office-based roles are expected in the office on two anchor days per week, set by each team. On the other days employees may work from home or from the office. Fully remote arrangements are possible for some roles and need approval from the department head and the People Team.

Employees working from home must have a quiet workspace and a reliable internet connection, and must follow the information security policy, including locking the screen and never printing confidential documents at home. The company provides a laptop, a monitor and a headset. A one-time home office allowance of up to 300 euros covers a chair or a desk; receipts must be submitted within three months of joining.

Working from another country is allowed for up to 20 working days per calendar year, and only from countries with no tax or visa restrictions listed by the People Team. Requests must be made at least two weeks in advance. Working abroad for longer periods is not allowed, because of tax and social security rules.

10. Unpaid leave and sabbaticals

After two years of service, employees may request unpaid leave of up to 3 months for personal reasons. After five years of service, employees may request a sabbatical of up to 6 months. Requests should be made at least three months in advance and need approval from the manager and the People Team. The employee's role, or an equivalent role, is kept during unpaid leave and sabbaticals.

11. Questions and changes

Questions about this policy go to the People Team through the HR portal. The People Team reviews this policy every year and will give employees at least one month of notice before any change that reduces an entitlement.